South Island Road Trip: Christchurch to Queenstown

6-14 March 2027 · 2 adults, 1 driver · 8 nights · about 2,160 km · plan prepared 9 November 2026

Verdict: the plan works within all your rules, but it is not booked yet and a few facts are still unconfirmed. Every day is under 500 km (the longest is 442 km). Every drive ends at least 47 minutes before the 30-minutes-before-sunset limit and starts after sunrise. Fuel stops cover every stretch, and the car is back at Queenstown Airport by 08:15 on 14 March. The plan has no boats, no beaches and no walk over about 1.5 hours. 5 of the 8 nights are at Accor hotels. The other 3 are in towns where Accor has no hotel. Not yet confirmed: hotel prices and two-bed availability against your NZ$300 limit, a few opening hours, and day-of track and road conditions (listed in section 7).

What you need to do next

1. **Book the one-way rental car** (Christchurch Airport 6 Mar about 15:30, return Queenstown Airport 14 Mar 08:15). March is high season, and the one-way fee varies a lot by company (GO Rentals quotes NZ$100-1,000), so compare totals.
2. **Book the 3 Queenstown Accor nights and Tekapo first**. They are the most in demand. Then Christchurch, then Franz Josef, Wanaka and Te Anau. Ask for two beds every time, and pick free-cancellation rates while things are uncertain.
3. **Decide on two optional extras:** a Franz Josef glacier helicopter flight with snow landing (day 3, weather-dependent), and a Tekapo night stargazing tour (day 4).

1. Your requirements, as I recorded them

Requirement	How the plan meets it
Land Christchurch Sat 6 Mar 14:30; fly from Queenstown Sun 14 Mar 11:00	Car collected about 15:45 on day 1; car returned 08:14 on day 9
One driver; at most 500 km a day	Longest day 442 km (day 2); average about 270 km
Never drive after dark	Every arrival is at least 30 min before sunset, plus at least 47 min spare; no start before sunrise
Accor as many nights as possible, otherwise anything decent; two beds; up to NZ$300 a night	5 Accor nights (Christchurch, Tekapo, Queenstown x3). Franz Josef, Wanaka and Te Anau have no Accor hotel. Prices are not yet checked.
See as much as possible; early starts fine	Most days start within 15 min of sunrise. More than 30 sights, lookouts and short walks are planned.
Interests: mountains, lookouts, lakes, glaciers, wildlife	3 glaciers (Franz Josef, Fox, Tasman); Aoraki/Mount Cook; Lakes Matheson, Pukaki, Tekapo, Wakatipu, Gunn; kea, kiwi, takahe
No boats or ferries; no beaches; no walk over about 2 hours	No boat anywhere, including no Milford Sound cruise. Coastal lookouts only. The longest walks are about 1.5 hr; Hooker Valley (3 hr+) is left out.
No sightseeing on 14 March	Hotel to airport only

Assumptions where you didn't say: a 2WD compact or intermediate petrol rental with a full-tank range of at least 600 km; your 14 March flight is international (I allowed 2 hr 45 min at the airport); about 75 min from landing to driving away; meals bought along the way (not budgeted).

2. Trip at a glance

Day	Date	Route	km	Driving	Leave	Arrive	Sunset
1	Sat 6 Mar	Christchurch Airport → Novotel Christchurch Airport	17	0h22	15:45	17:04	20:09
2	Sun 7 Mar	Novotel Christchurch Airport → Franz Josef / Waiau	442	6h06	07:25	17:57	20:16
3	Mon 8 Mar	Franz Josef / Waiau → Wanaka	307	4h17	07:30	19:02	20:20
4	Tue 9 Mar	Wanaka → Lake Tekapo	329	4h28	07:30	16:04	20:12
5	Wed 10 Mar	Lake Tekapo → Queenstown	273	4h12	09:40	16:52	20:18
6	Thu 11 Mar	Queenstown → Te Anau	410	5h44	07:40	17:33	20:20
7	Fri 12 Mar	Te Anau → Queenstown	267	3h38	08:00	14:29	20:15
8	Sat 13 Mar	Queenstown → Queenstown	108	2h19	08:30	15:42	20:13
9	Sun 14 Mar	Queenstown → Queenstown Airport	9	0h13	08:00	08:14	20:11

Driving times are router estimates. The clock times in the day plans add 10% for slower real-world driving, photo pull-overs and roadworks. Sunrise and sunset are calculated for each date and place.

3. Problems found while checking, and what I changed

1. **Running out of fuel on the Milford Road.** In the first draft, the tank reached Te Anau after about 640 km since the last fill-up (Twizel), well past a safe range. *Fix:* fill up in Queenstown/Frankton on the evening of day 5, in Te Anau before the Milford Road, and in Te Anau again on the way back. There is no reliable fuel between Te Anau and Milford Sound.
2. **Two mornings started before sunrise** (day 2 at 07:15, sunrise 07:19 at the first stop; day 6 at 07:30, sunrise 07:34). *Fix:* leave at 07:25 and 07:40.
3. **Willowbank closes before you'd finish on day 1.** You'd arrive about 16:00 with a 17:00 close. *Fix:* the visit is cut to 55 min. One listing says last entry is 16:00, so phone them. If it doesn't work out, you'll still see kiwi at Kiwi Park Queenstown on day 8.
4. **Long stretches without a break for a lone driver.** *Fix:* added a coffee stop at Harihari on day 2, and made the Devil's Staircase lookout a proper 15 min stop on days 6 and 7.
5. **Mt John summit road closes to cars at 16:00.** The day 4 arrival in Tekapo (16:04) is too late, so Mt John moves to 10:00 on day 5.
6. **Added sights where the day had room:** the Fox Glacier South Side walk and Fantail Falls on day 3. The day still ends 78 min before sunset. Arrowtown appeared twice, so it is now only on day 8.
7. **Only 5 of 8 nights can be Accor.** Accor has no hotel in Franz Josef, Wanaka or Te Anau. Getting more Accor nights would mean dropping the West Coast glaciers or the Milford Road, so I kept the sights. If Accor matters more to you, the trade-off is: skip Te Anau and Milford, and spend that night in Queenstown (6 Accor nights).

4. Day-by-day plan

Day 1: Sat 6 Mar - Arrive Christchurch, kiwi and kea at Willowbank

17 km · 0h22 driving (router time, before the 10% buffer) · sunrise 07:14 · sunset 20:09 · latest safe arrival about 19:39

Land 14:30. Allow about 75 min for immigration, biosecurity (declare food and hiking boots) and the rental desk, so the car is assumed to leave at 15:45.

Time	Stop and what to do	Leg
15:45	**Christchurch Airport** Collect the rental car (assumed on the road by 15:45).	
15:59-16:54	**Willowbank Wildlife Reserve** NZ native wildlife park 5 min from the airport: kiwi house, kea, eels. Listings disagree on closing (17:00, or 19:00 in summer) and last entry (one says 16:00). Ring 03 359 6226 before you fly. If you clear the airport late, skip it; Kiwi Park Queenstown on day 8 covers kiwi.	+10 km / 0h13
17:04	**Novotel Christchurch Airport** Accor. Right at the airport, so day 2 starts with no city traffic.	+7 km / 0h09

Day 2: Sun 7 Mar - Christchurch to Franz Josef over Arthur's Pass

442 km · 6h06 driving (router time, before the 10% buffer) · sunrise 07:15 · sunset 20:16 · latest safe arrival about 19:46

The longest driving day (442 km, about 6 hr at the wheel plus a 10% buffer) and you have one driver. Take every stop as a real break. If either of you is wrecked after the flight, drop Hokitika Gorge (about 60 km and 1.5 hr saved).

Time	Stop and what to do	Leg
07:25	**Novotel Christchurch Airport** Start.	
08:48-09:18	**Castle Hill / Kura Tawhiti** Kura Tawhiti limestone boulders, a flat 30 min wander from the roadside car park.	+90 km / 1h16
10:09-11:24	**Arthur's Pass village** Devil's Punchbowl Falls: 1 hr return, 400+ steps (DOC). Kea are often around the village. Do not feed them.	+53 km / 0h46
11:33-11:48	**Otira Viaduct Lookout** Lookout over the Otira Viaduct. Kea often visit the car park.	+6 km / 0h08
13:10-14:00	**Hokitika** Lunch and FUEL. Fill the tank here.	+93 km / 1h15
14:33-15:18	**Hokitika Gorge** Turquoise river gorge with a swing bridge (a bridge, not a boat), about 45 min.	+34 km / 0h30
16:49-17:04	**Harihari (coffee and toilet stop)** Coffee, toilets and a driver break before the last stretch.	+103 km / 1h23
17:57	**Franz Josef / Waiau** No Accor hotel in Franz Josef. Book a non-Accor hotel (see Hotels).	+62 km / 0h48

Day 3: Mon 8 Mar - Two glaciers, Lake Matheson, Haast Pass to Wanaka

307 km · 4h17 driving (router time, before the 10% buffer) · sunrise 07:26 · sunset 20:20 · latest safe arrival about 19:50

The busiest sightseeing day. If it is pouring on the West Coast, cut the Fox walk first. Lake Matheson is still worth it in cloud, and you gain 1.5 hr. Optional, weather permitting: a 20-40 min helicopter flight with a snow landing at 07:30 instead of the valley walk. It isn't a boat, but ask whether your seasick traveller is fine in a helicopter.

Time	Stop and what to do	Leg
07:30	**Franz Josef / Waiau** Start.	
07:38-09:08	**Franz Josef Glacier car park** Franz Josef Glacier / Ka Roimata o Hine Hukatere valley walk, about 1 to 1.5 hr return. It closes for floods and rockfall. Check the daily Glacier Country access update that morning. DOC trialled a parking fee here in 2025-26.	+5 km / 0h08
09:44-11:14	**Fox Glacier South Side Walkway car park** Fox Glacier South Side Walkway: rainforest track, first glacier viewpoint about 40 min in. Allow 1.5 hr return and turn back at the viewpoint (flood hazard beyond).	+28 km / 0h32
11:25-13:05	**Lake Matheson** Lake Matheson loop, about 1.5 hr. Calm mornings give the famous mirror view of Aoraki/Mount Cook and Mount Tasman. Cafe at the car park for lunch.	+7 km / 0h10
14:30-14:45	**Knights Point Lookout** Coastal lookout over the Tasman Sea. Roadside only, no beach.	+98 km / 1h18
15:10-15:40	**Haast** FUEL. Fill the tank: the next fuel is Makarora or Wanaka.	+28 km / 0h22
16:20-16:35	**Thunder Creek Falls** Waterfall 5 min from the road.	+50 km / 0h37
16:40-16:50	**Fantail Falls** Waterfall 2 min from the road.	+6 km / 0h04
17:02-18:02	**Blue Pools** Blue Pools: about 1 hr return through beech forest, with swing bridges over glacier-blue pools.	+15 km / 0h11
19:02	**Wanaka** No Accor hotel in Wanaka. On the way in, stop at the SH6 lookout over Lake Hawea at The Neck if you have time.	+70 km / 0h55

Day 4: Tue 9 Mar - Lindis Pass, Aoraki/Mount Cook glaciers, Lake Tekapo

329 km · 4h28 driving (router time, before the 10% buffer) · sunrise 07:30 · sunset 20:12 · latest safe arrival about 19:42

Leave on time: the glacier walks are best before the afternoon wind. The Tekapo arrival at 16:04 is too late for the Mt John road (it closes to cars at 16:00), so Mt John is first thing on day 5.

Time	Stop and what to do	Leg
07:30	**Wanaka** Start.	
08:39-08:49	**Lindis Pass summit** Tussock pass. Lookout at the summit car park.	+80 km / 1h03
09:43-10:03	**Twizel** FUEL. Fill up before Mount Cook (no fuel in Mount Cook village).	+63 km / 0h49
10:21-10:31	**Peter's Lookout** Classic view up Lake Pukaki to Aoraki/Mount Cook.	+21 km / 0h17
11:17-12:17	**Tasman Glacier car park** Tasman Glacier View track: about 40 min return but steep, 300+ steps. The terminal lake often has icebergs.	+49 km / 0h41
12:33-14:33	**White Horse Hill car park** Kea Point track: 1 hr return from this car park (DOC). Views of the Mueller Glacier, Mount Sefton and Aoraki/Mount Cook. Time allowed includes lunch (The Hermitage cafe is 2 km back). The Hooker Valley track (3 hr+) is left out under your 2-hour walking limit. It was also partly closed in 2026 for bridge works.	+10 km / 0h15
16:04	**Lake Tekapo** Accor (Peppers Bluewater or Mantra). Evening: Church of the Good Shepherd on foot. Optional night stargazing tour that collects you in town, so no night driving.	+105 km / 1h23

Day 5: Wed 10 Mar - Mt John summit, Lake Pukaki, Kawarau Gorge to Queenstown

273 km · 4h12 driving (router time, before the 10% buffer) · sunrise 07:27 · sunset 20:18 · latest safe arrival about 19:48

Fill the tank in Frankton as you arrive in Queenstown (needed for the Milford day). An easy morning: Church of the Good Shepherd on foot at sunrise, then Mt John when the road opens at 10:00. Evening on foot in Queenstown, e.g. the Skyline Gondola (a cable car, not a boat).

Time	Stop and what to do	Leg
09:40	**Lake Tekapo** Start.	
10:08-11:08	**Mt John Observatory summit** Mt John summit road: open 10:00-16:00, NZ$14 per car, shuts in bad weather (Dark Sky Project). 360-degree lookout and Astro Cafe.	+10 km / 0h26
12:11-12:31	**Lake Pukaki lookout** Lake Pukaki lookout at the visitor centre, at the south end of the lake.	+52 km / 0h57
14:38-15:23	**Cromwell Heritage Precinct** Old Cromwell heritage precinct on Lake Dunstan. Fruit stalls in season.	+150 km / 1h56
15:56-16:26	**Kawarau Gorge Suspension Bridge** Historic suspension bridge. Watch the bungy for free from the viewing deck.	+38 km / 0h30
16:52	**Queenstown** Accor (Novotel Queenstown Lakeside).	+23 km / 0h23

Day 6: Thu 11 Mar - The Milford Road (no cruise), overnight Te Anau

410 km · 5h44 driving (router time, before the 10% buffer) · sunrise 07:35 · sunset 20:20 · latest safe arrival about 19:50

The big scenery day: 410 km on a mountain road. Leave at 07:40 (sunrise 07:35). No mobile coverage beyond Te Anau Downs. Check the road status before leaving Te Anau (avalanche and rockfall closures are possible even in March).

Time	Stop and what to do	Leg
07:40	**Queenstown** Start.	
08:14-08:29	**Devil's Staircase lookout** Lookout over Lake Wakatipu on SH6. Also a driver break.	+34 km / 0h31
10:25-10:50	**Te Anau** FUEL: fill the tank before the Milford Road. Te Anau is the last reliable fuel. There may be a card-only pump at Milford, but don't rely on it.	+137 km / 1h46
11:39-11:54	**Mirror Lakes** Short boardwalk with Earl Mountains reflections, about 15 min.	+57 km / 0h44
12:12-12:57	**Lake Gunn Nature Walk** Lake Gunn Nature Walk: 45 min loop through red-beech forest.	+19 km / 0h17
13:24-13:54	**Homer Tunnel (east portal)** Homer Tunnel is one-way, with traffic lights. Waits of up to about 15 min are normal. Kea gather at the portal. Do not feed them, and watch your rubber seals.	+26 km / 0h24
14:04-14:29	**The Chasm** The Chasm: 20 min forest walk to carved rock and waterfalls.	+8 km / 0h09
14:43-15:43	**Milford Sound / Piopiotahi** Milford Sound / Piopiotahi from the shore: foreshore walk, Mitre Peak. No cruise (no boats, as you asked). No mobile coverage on most of this road.	+10 km / 0h13
17:33	**Te Anau** FUEL: fill the tank before the Milford Road. Te Anau is the last reliable fuel. There may be a card-only pump at Milford, but don't rely on it.	+118 km / 1h40

Day 7: Fri 12 Mar - Takahe at Te Anau, Glenorchy road lookouts

267 km · 3h38 driving (router time, before the 10% buffer) · sunrise 07:40 · sunset 20:15 · latest safe arrival about 19:45

A relaxed day after the Milford drive. Arrival in Queenstown at 14:29 leaves the afternoon free on foot.

Time	Stop and what to do	Leg
08:00	**Te Anau** Start.	
08:04-08:49	**Te Anau Bird Sanctuary** Te Anau Bird Sanctuary: free, open in daylight (DOC). Takahe, a rare flightless bird, plus kaka and kakariki.	+3 km / 0h04
10:46-11:01	**Devil's Staircase lookout** Lookout over Lake Wakatipu on SH6. Also a driver break.	+138 km / 1h46
11:57-12:12	**Bennetts Bluff Lookout** Bennetts Bluff: the best lookout on the Glenorchy road.	+58 km / 0h51
12:33-13:48	**Glenorchy** Lunch. The Glenorchy Lagoon boardwalk (about 1 hr) has mountain reflections and waterbirds.	+22 km / 0h19
14:29	**Queenstown** Accor (Novotel Queenstown Lakeside).	+46 km / 0h38

Day 8: Sat 13 Mar - Deer Park Heights, Crown Range, Arrowtown, Kiwi Park

108 km · 2h19 driving (router time, before the 10% buffer) · sunrise 07:37 · sunset 20:13 · latest safe arrival about 19:43

Short drives. Book Deer Park Heights for this date in advance. Refuel in Frankton for the morning car return.

Time	Stop and what to do	Leg
08:30	**Queenstown** Start.	
08:48-10:18	**Deer Park Heights** Deer Park Heights: a private farm drive to summit lookouts over Lake Wakatipu and The Remarkables, with tame deer, alpacas and other animals. It needs an online booking for the date. Reported price about NZ$75 per car, capped at about 80 cars a day.	+13 km / 0h17
11:18-11:58	**Crown Range Road lookouts and Cardrona** Crown Range Road: the zig-zag lookout on the way up, the summit at 1,076 m, and the historic Cardrona Hotel. Sat 13 March is Wanaka A&P Show day, so expect more traffic towards Wanaka.	+43 km / 0h54
12:44-13:44	**Arrowtown** Gold-rush village, lunch, Chinese Settlement walk (about 20 min).	+31 km / 0h42
14:09-15:39	**Kiwi Park Queenstown** Kiwi Park Queenstown, open 9:30-18:30 in summer, last entry 17:45. Kiwi, tuatara and kea. Afterwards, refill the tank in Frankton for the car return.	+21 km / 0h23
15:42	**Queenstown** Accor (Novotel Queenstown Lakeside).	+1 km / 0h03

Day 9: Sun 14 Mar - Return the car, fly 11:00

9 km · 0h13 driving (router time, before the 10% buffer) · sunrise 07:39 · sunset 20:11 · latest safe arrival about 19:41

No sightseeing, as you asked. Leave the hotel at 08:00 and return the car about 08:15. That is 2 hr 45 min before an 11:00 departure, enough for an international flight.

Time	Stop and what to do	Leg
08:00	**Queenstown** Start.	
08:14	**Queenstown Airport** Return the car and check in. Confirm the rental desk's Sunday hours.	+9 km / 0h13

5. Hotels (nothing booked yet)

Night	Town	Suggested	Accor?	Notes
Sat 6 Mar	Christchurch Airport	**Novotel Christchurch Airport**	Accor (Novotel)	Alternatives within Accor: ibis Christchurch, Novotel Christchurch Cathedral Square (city, 20 min further on day 2).
Sun 7 Mar	Franz Josef	**Non-Accor, e.g. Scenic Hotel Franz Josef Glacier**	Not Accor (none in town)	Small town: book early. Te Waonui Forest Retreat is likely over budget.
Mon 8 Mar	Wanaka	**Non-Accor, e.g. Wanaka Hotel**	Not Accor (no ALL-bookable hotel; 'Accor Vacation Club Wanaka' is a members' club)	Any well-reviewed motel with two queens is fine. The Wanaka A&P Show (12-13 Mar) is after you leave, so it won't fill the town on 8 Mar.
Tue 9 Mar	Lake Tekapo	**Peppers Bluewater Resort or Mantra Lake Tekapo**	Accor (Peppers / Mantra)	Ask for a lake-view room with two beds.
Wed 10 Mar	Queenstown	**Novotel Queenstown Lakeside**	Accor (Novotel)	Book all three Queenstown nights together if the price fits. Other Accor options: Mantra The Point, Peppers Beacon, Movenpick. Sofitel and Hotel St Moritz (MGallery) are luxury and likely over budget.
Thu 11 Mar	Te Anau	**Non-Accor, e.g. Distinction Luxmore Hotel**	Not Accor (none in town)	Central Te Anau, walking distance to restaurants and the bird sanctuary.
Fri 12 Mar	Queenstown	**Novotel Queenstown Lakeside**	Accor	
Sat 13 Mar	Queenstown	**Novotel Queenstown Lakeside**	Accor	15 min to the airport for the Sunday morning car return.

I could not check live prices. For each, confirm a room with two beds at NZ$300 or less a night for your dates. Queenstown in March is the most likely to go over: if Novotel is over NZ$300, try Mantra The Point or Peppers Beacon (both Accor) before leaving Accor. Late check-in isn't an issue: the latest arrival at any hotel is 19:02 (Wanaka).

6. Book or confirm next (in order)

1. **Rental car, one-way CHC to ZQN.** One named driver with an Australian licence, which is valid in New Zealand. NZTA now allows up to 18 months on an English-language overseas car licence; carry the physical card. Get unlimited km and a low or zero excess. Check that the Queenstown Airport desk is open about 08:15 on a Sunday. Most rental contracts exclude some roads, such as Skippers Road; this plan uses none of them, but read the list.
2. **Hotels:** Queenstown (3 nights) and Tekapo, then Christchurch, then Franz Josef, Wanaka and Te Anau. These small towns fill in March.
3. **Deer Park Heights** for Sat 13 March: online booking for that date, capped at about 80 cars a day.
4. **Optional:** Tekapo stargazing tour (night of 9 Mar); Franz Josef glacier helicopter flight (morning of 8 Mar; book a flexible fare, as flights are cancelled in cloud).
5. **Entry and insurance:** depending on your passports, you may need an NZeTA (Australian citizens don't). Get travel insurance that covers the rental car excess.
6. **The week before:** check the NZTA Journey Planner for SH73 Arthur's Pass, SH6 Haast Pass and SH94 Milford Road, and the MetService forecast for the West Coast and Fiordland.
7. **On the day:** the Glacier Country daily glacier access update (day 3), and the Milford Road status at Te Anau (day 6).

7. Still unknown, and how to find out

Unknown	Why it matters	How to check
Hotel prices and two-bed rooms for your dates	Your NZ$300 limit	Accor ALL app or website for the Accor nights; hotel websites for the rest
Willowbank closing and last-entry times	Day 1 is tight	willowbank.co.nz, or phone 03 359 6226
Franz Josef and Fox glacier walks open on 8 March	They close for floods and rockfall	Glacier Country daily update; DOC Westland visitor centre +64 3 752 0360
Planned roadworks or night closures on SH73, SH6 Haast and SH94 in 6-14 March 2027	Haast Pass and the Milford Road both have a history of slips and works closures	journeys.nzta.govt.nz a week before and on the morning
Fuel station hours at Hokitika, Haast, Twizel and Te Anau	Fuel plan depends on them; Haast is the remote one	Check on a fuel app (e.g. Gaspy) or with the station; most have 24 h card pumps
Your rental's real fuel range	I assumed at least 600 km a tank	Ask the rental company the model and tank size. Fill up at every planned stop anyway.
Deer Park Heights price and hours	Only third-party sources found	Its own website when you book

8. Driving notes for New Zealand

- Drive on the left, as in Australia. Many West Coast and Haast Pass bridges are **one lane**: a red arrow means give way.
- Open-road limits are usually 100 km/h, but bends make the real average much lower. The router times already reflect that.
- Sandflies are fierce on the West Coast and in Fiordland. Bring repellent.
- Don't feed kea: it is illegal and harms them. They also strip rubber off cars, so don't leave the car unattended near them for long.

- The West Coast gets heavy rain. If it is pouring, swap order within the day, not across days. Every day has spare daylight.
- Only one driver: day 2 (6 hr at the wheel) and day 6 (5.7 hr) are the tiring ones, so get an early night before each.

9. What this check can't tell you

Distances come from OpenStreetMap routing, and drive times are router estimates plus a 10% buffer. Sunset times are calculated. The check doesn't know about live road closures, slips, flooding or snow, whether a track is open on the day, how tired the driver will be, or whether a place is worth your time. Check the NZTA Journey Planner and MetService shortly before each long drive, especially Haast Pass (day 3) and the Milford Road (day 6).

Sources (checked 9 November 2026)

- Accor South Island hotel list: https://all.accor.com/gb/region/hotels-south-island-new-zealand-re14.shtml
- Peppers Bluewater Resort (Accor): https://all.accor.com/B3Q7
- Wanaka A&P Show 12-13 March 2027: https://www.wanakashow.co.nz/news/introducing-the-title-partner-for-our-landmark-90th-show/
- Mt John road and Astro Cafe hours, NZ$14 fee: https://www.darkskyproject.co.nz/eat/astro-cafe/
- DOC Aoraki/Mount Cook walking tracks (Kea Point, Tasman Glacier View): https://dxcprod.doc.govt.nz/globalassets/documents/parks-and-recreation/tracks-and-walks/canterbury/aoraki/walking-and-cycling-tracks-in-aoraki-mt-cook.pdf
- DOC Devil's Punchbowl walk: https://dxcprod.doc.govt.nz/parks-and-recreation/places-to-go/canterbury/places/arthurs-pass-national-park/things-to-do/tracks/devils-punchbowl-walking-track
- DOC Franz Josef Glacier walk (daily access updates): https://doc.govt.nz/parks-and-recreation/places-to-go/west-coast/places/westland-tai-poutini-national-park/things-to-do/tracks/franz-josef-glacier-ka-roimata-o-hine-hukarere-walk
- DOC Fox Glacier South Side Walkway: https://dxcprod.doc.govt.nz/parks-and-recreation/places-to-go/west-coast/places/westland-tai-poutini-national-park/things-to-do/tracks/fox-glacier-south-side-walk
- DOC Te Anau Bird Sanctuary: https://doc.govt.nz/teanaubirdsanctuary
- Milford Road fuel advice: https://nzpocketguide.com/15-stops-cant-miss-road-to-milford-sound/
- Kiwi Park Queenstown hours: https://kiwibird.co.nz/visit/plan-your-visit/
- Willowbank Wildlife Reserve: https://willowbank.co.nz/plan-your-visit/
- Deer Park Heights (third-party guide): https://www.rexby.com/Littlekiwitravels/ttd/gobsmacking-views-animals-and-lord-of-the-rings-film-sites
- NZTA: driving on an overseas licence: https://nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences/new-residents-and-visitors/driving-on-nz-roads/time-limit-extended-for-driving-on-an-overseas-licence
- GO Rentals one-way fee CHC to ZQN: https://www.gorentals.co.nz/services/one-way-car-rental/christchurch-to-queenstown/
- NZTA Journey Planner (road closures): https://www.journeys.nzta.govt.nz/
- Distances and drive times: OpenStreetMap / OSRM router, routed 9 Nov 2026: https://router.project-osrm.org